Malware & Ransomware Attacks on Systems

Five Real-World Case Studies

Servers, corporates, hospitals, banks and government bodies – India and worldwide

Overview of the five cases

#	Case	Date	Region	Reported loss
1	WannaCry ransomware (NHS and 150 countries)	May 2017	Worldwide / UK	About £92 million for the NHS alone
2	NotPetya on Maersk	June 2017	Worldwide	$250–300 million for Maersk
3	Colonial Pipeline (DarkSide)	May 2021	USA	$4.4 million ransom paid; fuel supply halted
4	AIIMS Delhi ransomware	Nov 2022	India	Hospital services on manual mode for days; no official cost published
5	Cosmos Bank, Pune	Aug 2018	India	₹94.42 crore (about $13.5 million)

Note: Figures are as reported by the news articles and official reports listed under each case. Where a recovery cost was never officially published, this is stated instead of guessing.

Case 1: WannaCry Ransomware (2017)

Date / timing	Started 12 May 2017; spread within a day; slowed on 13 May 2017 when a kill switch was activated.
Victims	Over 200,000 computers in about 150 countries, including the UK National Health Service (NHS), FedEx, Honda, Renault, Nissan UK and Telefonica.
Type of attack	Self-spreading ransomware worm. Files were locked and a Bitcoin ransom was demanded.
Cause	Exploited a critical vulnerability in Microsoft Windows for which a patch existed but had not been applied on many machines. Outdated systems and slow patching at the NHS made it spread easily. The malware was not aimed only at the NHS; it spread to anything vulnerable.
Loss	About 80 NHS hospital trusts and 8% of GP practices disrupted; around 19,000 appointments cancelled in one week.
Recovery	British researcher Marcus Hutchins found an unregistered web domain inside the malware and registered it, which acted as a kill switch and stopped it spreading. Affected organisations then patched Windows and restored systems.
Recovery cost	An estimated £92 million for the NHS (lost services plus IT costs afterwards), per a UK Department of Health report. This is a rough estimate.
Solution / lessons	Apply security patches quickly; replace unsupported operating systems. Keep offline backups and segment networks so one infection cannot reach everything. UK and US governments later blamed North Korea.

What happened

On 12 May 2017 the WannaCry worm began infecting Windows computers worldwide. Users saw red-lettered messages demanding Bitcoin to unlock their files. In England, hospitals had to cancel operations and appointments and divert patients.

The spread was slowed by a researcher who noticed an unusual domain name in the code and registered it. Experts warned that versions without a kill switch could be made, so patching remained the real long-term fix.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **National Health Executive: WannaCry cost the NHS £92m –** https://www.nationalhealthexecutive.com/articles/wannacry-cyber-attack-cost-nhs-ps92m-after-19000-appointments-were-cancelled
- **The Washington Times (11 Oct 2018): UK Department of Health report –** https://www.washingtontimes.com/news/2018/oct/11/wannacry-cyberattack-cost-british-government-over-/
- **The Open University: What was the attack? –** https://www.open.edu/openlearn/digital-computing/learning-major-cyber-security-incidents/content-section-2.1

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BRITAIN'S BEST-SELLING QUALITY DAILY MONDAY 15 MAY 2017 | £1.60

The Daily Telegraph

May heads to Brussels for crucial euro talks
Page 6



The making of a Lion rugby special
Pages 14–15



Why walking is the new mindfulness
Page 24



GLOBAL CYBER BLITZKRIEG: NHS HOSPITALS PARALYZED

Ransomware attack hits hospitals and businesses across world

By Charles Hymas and Kate McCann

Hospitals across Britain were forced to cancel operations and turn away patients yesterday after a massive cyber-attack swept across the globe, crippling NHS computer systems.

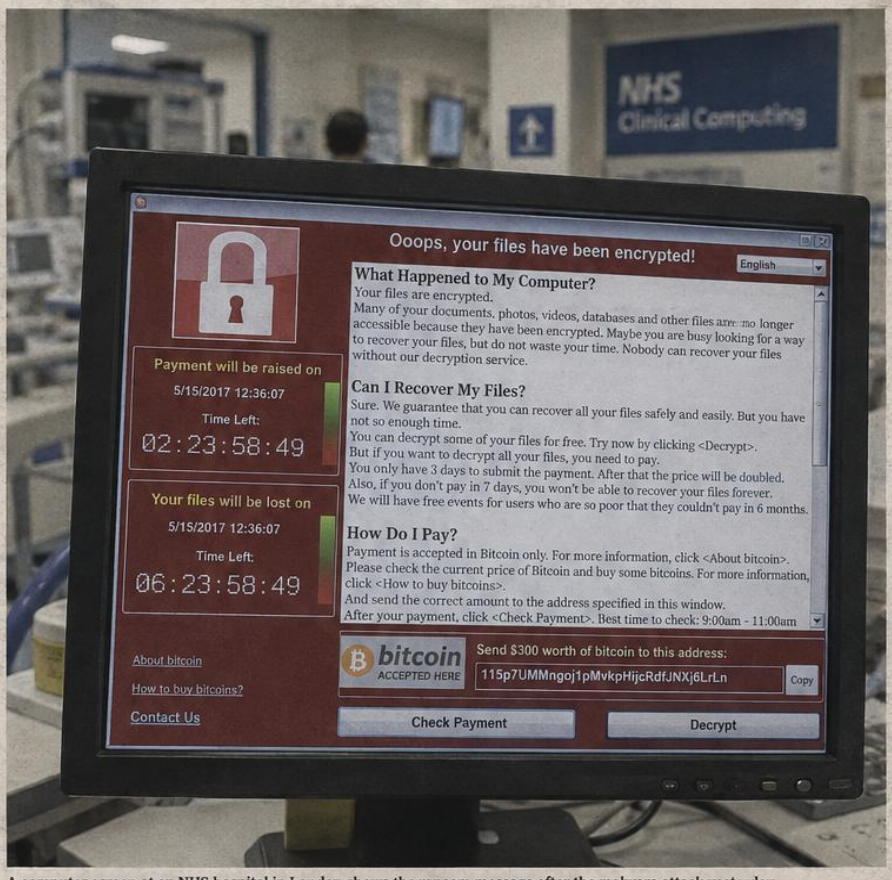
The unprecedented hacker assault, believed to be the work of a group using ransomware known as WannaCry, has hit organisations in more than 150 countries, causing widespread disruption to healthcare, transport and business.

NHS Digital confirmed that several NHS trusts were affected, with outpatient appointments cancelled and some A&E departments forced to divert patients to other hospitals.

One NHS worker, who did not wish to be named, said: "Our systems just went down. We couldn't access patient records and had to go back to pen and paper. It's like something out of a disaster movie."

The attack has prompted urgent warnings from the National Cyber Security Centre for organisations to ensure they have the latest security updates installed.

Continued on Page 4



A computer screen at an NHS hospital in London shows the ransom message after the malware attack yesterday

Students caught in fresh tuition fees row
Page 8

Trump in new Russia storm
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Markets hit as virus spreads
Page 11

Fears for vital services if attack continues
Page 13

Case 2: NotPetya Attack on Maersk (2017)

Date / timing	27 June 2017 (malware was planted in a software update on 22 June 2017).
Victim	A.P. Moller–Maersk, the world's largest container shipping company, along with many other global firms (for example Merck and FedEx TNT).
Type of attack	Destructive malware that looked like ransomware (a 'wiper').
Cause	Attackers compromised the update server of Ukrainian accounting software M.E.Doc and pushed NotPetya out as a trusted update. It then spread inside networks using the same Windows weakness as WannaCry plus stolen passwords. US, UK and other governments attributed it to Russian military intelligence (GRU).
Loss	Maersk lost almost its entire global IT system within hours, including domain controllers. About 80% of shipping volume had to be handled manually for ten days. Many port terminals were disrupted.
Recovery	One domain controller in Maersk's Ghana office survived because a power cut had taken it offline before the attack. It was used to rebuild the network. Maersk reinstalled about 4,000 servers, 45,000 PCs and 2,500 applications in around ten days, work that would normally take about six months.
Recovery cost	Maersk estimated total damage at $250–300 million. Total NotPetya damage across all victims is estimated at over $10 billion.
Solution / lessons	Maersk's chairman said the company found it was only average in cybersecurity and set out to improve it. Key lessons: patching, network segmentation, protected backups of domain controllers, and checking updates from software suppliers.

What happened

NotPetya was aimed at Ukraine, but it spread worldwide through company networks that had offices there. Maersk's ships kept moving, but port and booking systems went down. Staff worked with paper and phones while engineers rebuilt the IT estate.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **SC Media: NotPetya attack totally destroyed Maersk's computer network –** https://scmagazine.com/news/notpetya-attack-totally-destroyed-maersks-computer-network-chairman
- **Supply Chain Dive: Maersk's recovery after Nyetya –** https://www.supplychaindive.com/news/ocean-shipping-maersk-herculean-resilience-malware-devastation-nyetya-infrastructure/518494
- **Control Engineering: The NotPetya attack that took down Maersk –** https://www.controleng.com/?p=123809

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GLOBAL TRADE
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FINANCIAL SHIPPING TIMES

SHIPPING
MARKETS
PEOPLE
INSIGHT

VOL. 24 NO. 172 WEDNESDAY, JUNE 28, 2017 £2.00

Container rates hold firm despite turmoil
PAGE 3

European ports face growing digital risk
PAGE 5

Maersk says recovery may take weeks
PAGE 7

SHIPPING TITAN MAERSK CRIPPLED IN GLOBAL CYBER BLITZ



Container trucks queue outside security gates at the Port of Rotterdam on June 27, 2017, as terminal operations were halted following a global cyber attack that severely disrupted Maersk and other shipping operators. REUTERS

COPENHAGEN — June 28, 2017 — A global cyber attack using a new strain of destructive malware, believed to be NotPetya, has severely crippled A.P. Moller - Maersk, the world's largest container shipping company, disrupting operations at ports across Europe and forcing terminals to halt cargo handling, the company said on Wednesday.

Maersk confirmed that the malware, which security researchers say functions as a wiper rather than a ransomware, rapidly spread through its global network on Tuesday, encrypting and destroying data on thousands of computers and servers. Core systems including booking, terminal operations, email and internal communications were rendered inoperable, forcing many offices and port facilities to revert to manual processes.

The attack has caused significant disruption at European container ports, including Rotterdam, Antwerp and Hamburg, where truck queues stretched for kilometres and vessels faced delays. Port authorities reported that automated gate systems and container tracking platforms were among the systems affected.

Maersk said it was working with international cyber security experts to contain the outbreak and rebuild affected systems, but warned that full recovery could take weeks. "We are experiencing a major disruption to our IT systems across the company," the group said in a statement. "Our focus is on safely maintaining operations and supporting our customers as we work to restore our systems."

Security firms have linked the NotPetya malware to the same tools used in previous attacks attributed to the Russian-linked group known as the Shadow Brokers. The malware spreads laterally through networks using compromised Windows credentials and overwrites the master boot record, rendering infected machines unable to start.

Maersk said there was no evidence that customer data had been stolen, but acknowledged that the scale of the destruction meant many systems would have to be rebuilt from scratch. Industry analysts warned that the incident highlighted the growing vulnerability of global trade to cyber attacks, with shipping and port operations increasingly reliant on interconnected digital systems.

"This is a wake-up call for the entire maritime sector," said one Copenhagen-based analyst. "Cyber risk is now an operational risk."

Case 3: Colonial Pipeline Ransomware (2021)

Date / timing	Attack detected 7 May 2021; the company shut down its pipeline the same day and it was offline for several days.
Victim	Colonial Pipeline, the largest fuel pipeline in the USA, supplying roughly half the fuel used on the East Coast.
Type of attack	Ransomware by the DarkSide group (Russia-linked).
Cause	Attackers entered through a single compromised VPN password, according to the security firm Mandiant. A control room employee found a ransom note on screen.
Loss	Fuel supply along the East Coast was disrupted. Colonial shut the pipeline to stop the attack reaching its operating systems.
Recovery	Colonial paid about $4.4 million (75 Bitcoin) and received a decryption key to restart faster.
Recovery cost	The $4.4 million ransom. On 7 June 2021 the US Justice Department said the FBI recovered about $2.3 million of it (63.7 Bitcoin) by getting access to the attackers' Bitcoin wallet.
Solution / lessons	Use multi-factor authentication on remote access such as VPNs; remove unused accounts. Report attacks to law enforcement quickly; the FBI generally advises against paying ransoms.

What happened

The attack hit Colonial's business IT systems, and the company took its pipeline offline as a precaution. The incident led to public panic buying of fuel in parts of the USA and became a turning point in how governments treat ransomware.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **TechTarget: FBI seized Colonial Pipeline ransom from DarkSide affiliate –** https://www.techtarget.com/cybersecurity/news/252513302/FBI-seized-Colonial-Pipeline-ransom-from-DarkSide-affiliate
- **Computing.co.uk: US recovers most of ransom paid to Colonial Pipeline hackers –** https://www.computing.co.uk/news/4032526/us-recovers-most-usd-million-ransom-paid-colonial-pipeline-hackers
- **PBS NewsHour / AP: Department of Justice officials discuss Colonial Pipeline –** https://www.pbs.org/newshour/nation/watch-live-department-of-justice-officials-discuss-colonial-pipeline-ransomware-attack

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TRUTH INFORMS A STRONGER TOMORROW

THE EAST COAST TRIBUNE

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FUEL ARTERY SHUT DOWN IN MASSIVE RANSOMWARE STRIKE

Colonial Pipeline halts operations after cyberattack

Disruption sparks fuel shortages, long lines and rising anxiety across Southeast

By Rebecca T. Hammond and Daniel Krauss
Staff Writers

ATLANTA — Monday, May 10, 2021 — Colonial Pipeline Co. shut down all operations Friday after a ransomware attack forced the company to take its critical fuel network offline, triggering widespread disruption across the Southeast and renewed concerns about the vulnerability of the nation's infrastructure.

The Atlanta-based company, which transports roughly 45 percent of the fuel consumed on the East Coast, said it halted pipeline operations late Friday as a precaution after detecting a cyberattack. The company later confirmed the attack was carried out by a criminal group known as DarkSide, which has since claimed responsibility and is demanding a multimillion-dollar ransom, according to cybersecurity researchers familiar with the matter.

"Colonial made the decision to take our systems offline to contain the threat and prevent further damage," the company said in a statement. "We are working around the clock to safely and securely restore operations."

See PIPELINE, Page A6



DAVID R. CARTER / THE EAST COAST TRIBUNE

Motorists wait in a long line for fuel Sunday in Atlanta as numerous stations across the region remained out of service following the Colonial Pipeline shutdown. Many pumps were covered and unavailable after the company halted operations due to a ransomware attack.

Ransomware group DarkSide takes blame, seeks payment

Hackers demand millions as officials warn of prolonged disruption

By Michael Tan
Cybersecurity Correspondent

The ransomware group DarkSide has claimed responsibility for the attack on Colonial Pipeline, according to a statement posted on a dark web site monitored by researchers, and is demanding a large ransom payment, believed to be in the tens of millions of dollars, in exchange for a decryption key.

DarkSide, a relatively new but highly sophisticated cybercriminal group, is known for targeting large organizations and exfiltrating sensitive data before encrypting systems. In a message posted over the weekend, the group said it had "taken control" of Colonial's network and warned that leaked data would work and warned that leaked data would be published if its demands are not met.

"Our goal is money, not chaos," the group wrote. "Pay and we will provide the decryption tool and guarantee that your data will not be published."

See DARKSIDE, Page A7

Drivers face long lines and growing angst

Gas stations across Southeast report shortages as demand surges

By Karen Fields
Staff Writer

ATLANTA — Motorists across the Southeast spent the weekend in long lines at gas stations, with many pumps out of service and supplies running low, as the effects of the Colonial Pipeline shutdown rippled through the region.

In Atlanta, some drivers waited more than an hour for fuel, while others were turned away entirely after stations ran dry. Similar scenes played out in Georgia, the Carolinas, Virginia and beyond, as lawmakers and industry officials urged the public to avoid panic buying.

"I've never seen anything like this," said Marcus Ellison, a truck driver from Macon, who had been in line for nearly two hours. "People are anxious, and you can feel it. This pipeline is a lifeline for the East Coast."

State officials said they are working with federal agencies and fuel suppliers to monitor inventories and maintain supply where possible.

See SHORTAGES, Page A8

Biden briefed on attack, assures public of support Page A4

What is DarkSide? A closer look at the group behind the breach Page A7

Experts: More cyberattacks likely as criminals see opportunity Page A9

Communities prepare for potential extended disruption Page A10

Case 4: AIIMS Delhi Ransomware Attack (India, 2022)

Date / timing	23 November 2022. First sign at about 6:45–7:00 am when the emergency lab could not view reports.
Victim	All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), New Delhi, a major government hospital.
Type of attack	Suspected ransomware on the e-Hospital system run by the National Informatics Centre (NIC).
Cause	Ransomware infected the e-Hospital and Laboratory Information System servers. Infected files changed extensions, which pointed to ransomware. A government source reported to ANI that the attack originated in China and that 5 physical servers out of 100 (40 physical, 60 virtual) were infiltrated. This is an official-source claim reported by media.
Loss	Appointments, billing, smart lab and report generation went offline; OPD, IPD and labs ran manually for days. Reports said data of up to 40 million patients might have been exposed (reported as a possibility, not confirmed).
Recovery	Delhi Police registered a case of extortion and cyber terrorism on 25 November 2022 (IFSO unit). CERT-In, NIA, CBI and IB also probed. Data was restored from backups onto new, scanned servers by 29–30 November; the network was sanitised before services resumed. Infected servers were physically removed on police instructions. Online OPD registration resumed around 6 December 2022.
Recovery cost	No official figure for the recovery cost has been published. Media reports of a ₹200 crore crypto demand were denied by Delhi Police.
Solution / lessons	Maintain offline or separate backups; the e-Hospital backup was restored from a replica. Regular security audits and network segmentation for hospital systems.

What happened

Staff first noticed the problem when lab reports would not open. Within hours the e-Hospital servers were down and the hospital switched to paper records. Investigators from several agencies took part, and services were brought back in stages over about two weeks.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **Scroll.in: How AIIMS is working to restore services after the cyberattack –** https://scroll.in/latest/1038702/how-aiims-is-working-to-restore-services-after-hackers-crippled-its-computer-systems
- **Healthcare IT News: AIIMS Delhi restores e-hospital server data –** https://www.healthcareitnews.com/news/asia/aiims-delhi-restores-e-hospital-server-data
- **The Pioneer (PTI): Online registration of OPD patients resumes at AIIMS-Delhi –** https://www.dailypioneer.com/2022/top-stories/online-registration-of-opd-patients-resumes-at-aiims-delhi.html
- **Deccan Herald (PTI): AIIMS server down, agencies probe, FIR filed –** https://www.deccanherald.com/amp/story/india%2Faiims-server-down-various-agencies-looking-into-incident-delhi-police-file-fir-1165511.html

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TRUTH IN A CHANGING INDIA

THE CAPITAL HERALD

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NEW DELHI — FRIDAY, NOV 25, 2022 VOL. 14 NO. 318 | 16 PAGES | ₹10.00 www.thecapitalherald.in

AIIMS SERVERS CRIPPLED BY RANSOMWARE, WARDS REVERT TO PAPER

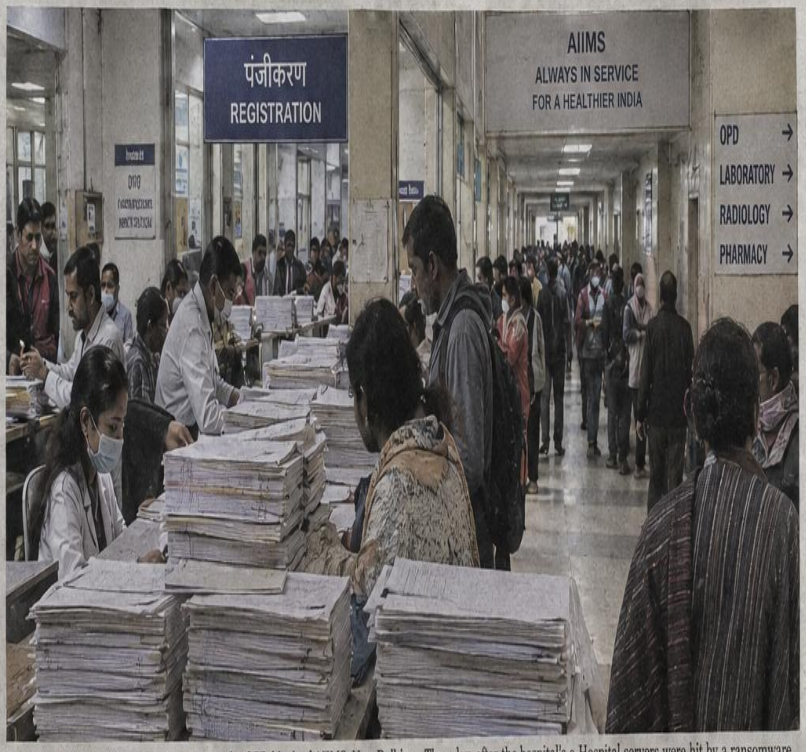
NIC e-Hospital system offline; manual OPD operations across AIIMS, say officials

CH REPORTER
NEW DELHI

The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) is battling a major disruption after its e-Hospital servers, hosted by the National Informatics Centre (NIC), were crippled by a ransomware attack, forcing hospital staff to revert to manual, paper-based processes for outpatient and inpatient services, officials said on Thursday.

The incident, which came to light earlier this week, has affected registration, appointment scheduling, laboratory reporting and billing modules at the country's premier medical institution. Long queues were seen outside the OPD blocks on Thursday as patients filled out paper forms and waited for manual registration.

"Our e-Hospital system is currently not functional due to a cyber incident. As a temporary measure, OPD services are being run manually to ensure that patient care is not affected," an AIIMS official said.



Patients queue up for manual registration at the OPD block of AIIMS, New Delhi, on Thursday, after the hospital's e-Hospital servers were hit by a ransomware attack. Hospital staff are maintaining records on paper as IT systems remain offline. PHOTO: SANJAY MEHTA / THE CAPITAL HERALD

Patients show remarkable patience, say doctors PAGE 4

'Stronger cybersecurity needed in public health infrastructure' PAGE 6

Not just a technical issue, but a wake-up call PAGE 8

Other govt hospitals on alert after AIIMS breach PAGE 8

FIR lodged for cyber terrorism; probe on, says Delhi Police

CH NEWS SERVICE
NEW DELHI

Delhi Police have registered an FIR under the Information Technology Act and sections related to cyber terrorism following the ransomware attack on AIIMS servers, officials confirmed on Thursday.

The case has been handed over to the Special Cell's cyber unit, which is working with NIC and other agencies to trace the source of the attack.

Preliminary inputs suggest the servers were encrypted using a sophisticated ransomware variant, a senior officer said. "The motive, group behind the attack and any demand for ransom are being investigated. At this stage, we are treating it as a case of cyber terrorism," the officer said.

NIC teams are working to restore systems, but there is no confirmed timeline for full recovery.

Case 5: Cosmos Bank Malware Attack, Pune (India, 2018)

Date / timing	11 August 2018 (ATM card withdrawals) and 13 August 2018 (SWIFT transfers).
Victim	Cosmos Co-operative Bank, Pune, one of India's oldest and biggest co-operative banks.
Type of attack	Malware on the bank's ATM switch server, followed by fraudulent SWIFT transfers.
Cause	Malware on the ATM switch server stole details of Visa and RuPay debit cards. According to the FIR, a proxy switch was created so that fraudulent payments were approved by the attackers' own system instead of the real network. The core banking system was not attacked, according to the bank.
Loss	₹94.42 crore (about $13.5 million) in total. About ₹78 crore through more than 12,000 Visa card transactions in 28 countries; about ₹2.5 crore from 2,849 transactions in India; and ₹13.92 crore sent by SWIFT to ALM Trading Ltd at Hang Seng Bank, Hong Kong.
Recovery	Visa flagged the suspicious transactions. The bank shut its Visa/RuPay payment system, net banking and servers, filed an FIR at Chatushringi police station and hired a forensic agency. Police arrested at least 18 people, mainly money mules. In April 2023 a Pune court convicted 11 people (reported by Business Standard).
Recovery cost	The bank said no customer accounts were affected and that the bank bore the loss itself. Police recovered some money from customers who withdrew excess balances during the attack. A full recovery figure has not been published.
Solution / lessons	Monitor card transactions in real time; secure and separate ATM switch servers. FBI had warned banks days earlier about a coordinated ATM cash-out threat, so alerts need quick action.

What happened

For about two hours on 11 August the bank saw repeated unusual transactions on Visa and RuPay cards across ATMs worldwide. Two days later the attackers also tried SWIFT transfers to Hong Kong. The case is among India's biggest bank cyber thefts.

Proof of source (original articles)

- **Hindustan Times / PressReader (15 Aug 2018): ₹94 crore stolen as gang hacks Pune bank –** https://www.pressreader.com/india/hindustan-times-lucknow/20180815/281848644440575
- **Moneylife (IANS): Hackers transfer Rs94 crore from Pune's Cosmos Bank –** https://www.moneylife.in/article/hackers-transfer-rs94-crore-from-punes-cosmos-bank/55022.html
- **Business Today: Cosmos Bank ATM server hacked –** https://www.businesstoday.in/amp/industry/banks/story/pune-cosmos-bank-atm-server-hacked-rs-94-crore-transferred-to-overseas-accounts-109361-2018-08-14
- **Business Standard: Cosmos Bank fraud (conviction report, April 2023) –** https://business-standard.com/amp/topic/cosmos-bank-fraud

Conclusion: Common causes and common fixes

Across all five cases, the same weaknesses appear again and again:

- Unpatched or outdated software (WannaCry, NotPetya).
- Weak access control, such as one stolen VPN password (Colonial Pipeline).
- Poorly separated networks that let one infection reach everything (Maersk, AIIMS).
- Slow detection of unusual activity (Cosmos Bank).

The most effective defences are regular patching, multi-factor authentication, tested offline backups, network segmentation, 24x7 monitoring, and a rehearsed incident response plan.

Important note for submission

- The dashed boxes in each case are for you to paste a screenshot of the original article. Open the link under 'Proof of source', take a screenshot of the headline and date, and paste it in. Do not paste whole articles; keep the screenshot as a small proof image and keep the links.

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INDIA ON A STRONGER GROWTH PATH Page 10

Rupee volatile amid global jitters Page 12

Vol. 11 No. 224 | Pune | Wednesday, August 15, 2018 www.mfchronicle.in 16 Pages | ₹5.00

BREAKING NEWS

₹94 CRORE SIPHONED IN SIMULTANEOUS GLOBAL ATM CYBER HEIST

Hackers clone bank's proxy switch server; carry out debit card withdrawals in 28 countries

PUNE — Wednesday, Aug 15, 2018

In one of the largest cyber frauds ever reported from India, ₹94 crore was siphoned off from the accounts of Cosmos Co-operative Bank through a sophisticated cyber attack that enabled simultaneous ATM withdrawals across 28 countries, bank and officials said on Tuesday.

The attackers cloned the bank's proxy ATM switch server, replicating it to authorise fraudulent transactions abroad, according to preliminary findings by officials familiar with the investigation. Using the cloned system, the hackers were able to circumvent security controls and process international debit card withdrawals in a short span of time.

The fraudulent transactions took place between August 10 and August 13, with withdrawals reported from countries including the United States, the United Kingdom, Canada, Germany, France, Spain, Australia, Japan and several others, said a senior official from the bank.

"The transactions were nearly simultaneous, which indicates the use of a cloned switch server and automated scripts," the official said. "This was a highly attack."



CCTV footage shows a suspect withdrawing cash from an ATM abroad using a cloned card linked to Cosmos Co-operative Bank accounts. PHOTO: BANK OFFICIALS / AFP

HOW THE FRAUD TOOK PLACE

- Hackers gain access to bank's network and clone proxy ATM switch server
- Cloned server used to authorise international debit card transactions
- Withdrawals carried out simultaneously in 28 countries between Aug 10–13
- Total amount siphoned off: ₹94 crore
- Fraud detected after unusual activity flagged by monitoring systems

Cosmos Co-operative Bank, headquartered in Pune, said it detected the suspicious activity on August 13 and immediately shut down the affected systems. The bank has filed a complaint with cyber crime authorities and is working with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and global payment networks to trace the funds.

RBI officials said the incident highlights the growing sophistication of cyber threats facing the banking sector. "We are closely monitoring the situation and have advised all banks to review and strengthen their ATM and switch infrastructure security," an RBI spokesperson said.

The investigation is ongoing, and no arrests have been made so far.

Continued on Page 4